

Curriculum Vitae — Michael F Bergmann

Associate Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University

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Employment

- **2024-01 – present** — Associate Professor (Tenured), Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University
- **2024-01 – TODO-EN** — Associate Director, Design + Technology Lab, Toronto Metropolitan University
- **2019-08 – 2024-01** — Assistant Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University
- **2022-07 – 2023-07** — Co-Undergraduate Program Director (Production), Performance, The Creative School, TMU
- **2017 – present** — Full Member, Yeates School of Graduate Studies, TMU
- **2016-08 – 2019-08** — Assistant Professor (Limited Term Faculty), Performance, The Creative School, TMU
- **2014 – 2016** — Technology Specialist / Media Server Programmer, WorldStage LAB, San Francisco / New York
- **2007 – 2010** — Projection Specialist, Meet The Dude Productions, Toronto

Education

- **2022-09 – present** — PhD (in progress), Critical Studies in Improvisation, University of Guelph. Expected 2027.
- **2011 – 2014** — MFA, Design (Projection Design Specialization), Yale School of Drama, Yale University
- **2006 – 2011** — BFA, Theatre Performance Production, Ryerson Theatre School, Toronto Metropolitan University (coursework completed December 2010; graduated May 2011)

Teaching Training and Certifications

- **2020** — Teaching Adult Learners Online, Chang School of Continuing Education, TMU
- **2019** — SEDA Recognised Teacher, University Teaching Development Programme (SEDA, UK and Ireland)
- **2019** — Apple Certified Teacher, Apple
- **2018** — Watchout Certified User and Operator, Dataton
- **2015** — Pandoras Box Certified, Christie

Awards and Distinctions

- **2022** — Best World Feature Film: Nuptials, Austin Revolution Film Festival (as producer)
- **2014** — Best Production: He Left Quietly, SummerWorks Performance Festival (as designer)
- **2012 – 2014** — Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University (\$40,000 USD; held throughout the MFA)
- **2009** — Spirit of the Fringe, Prague Fringe Festival

Residencies and Invited Positions

- **2025-12 – 2026-02** — Mentor, Setsubun Digital Media Residency, Japanese Canadian Cultural Centre, Toronto
- **2024-06** — Artist-in-residence, SÍM Residency (with UKAI Projects), Reykjavík, Iceland — Shipwreck, June 2–30, 2024
- **2022-04** — Artist-in-residence, Ingenuity Labs Research Institute, Queen’s University, Kingston
- **2021-09 – 2022** — Ferment AI Residency artist

Publications

- **2022-07** — Bouchard, D., Cristiá, C., Bergmann, M., and Robert, D. (2022). “Augmented Symphony: An augmented reality application for immersive music listening.” Proceedings of EVA London 2022, Electronic Workshops in Computing, BCS Learning & Development, London, UK, July 4–8, 2022. DOI: 10.14236/ewic/EVA2022.39.
- **2022-05** — Cristiá, C., Bouchard, D., Bergmann, M., et al. (2022). Orchestra Remote Delivery during COVID-19 Database. Open data set, Open Science Framework, May 5, 2022. DOI: 10.17605/OSF.IO/WCDU2.
- **2021** — Bergmann, M. F., and McGuire, B. (2021). “Uncanny Text.” Belfield Literary Review: New TransAtlantic Dialogues, ed. Gregory Betts and Lucy Collins, Spring 2021, pp. 96–99.

Forthcoming

- **2026** — Bergmann, M. “Cultivating Empathy through Robotic Performance.” Chapter in Robots and Other Artificial Agents on Stage: Theoretical Concepts and Artistic Practices, edited by Erica Magris and Izabella Pluta, transcript Verlag (Theatre Studies series). [pages TODO] [in press — confirm with editors]
- **2026** — Bergmann, M., and McLeod, K. “Improvising with Commercial AI: Questions of Care and Ethics.” [in draft — do not list on SSHRC docs until submitted]

Conference Presentations

- **2025-09** — Bergmann, M. “Hallucinating Children: Improvisation After the Algorithmic Shipwreck.” Hugarflug: Unstable Systems, annual conference on artistic research, Iceland University of the Arts, Reykjavík, Iceland, September 12, 2025.
- **2024-10** — Bergmann, M. “Beyond Tools: Reimagining Technology as Co-Participants in Performance Design.” PQ Symposium: Technologies in Theatre, Performance and Exhibition Design, Prague, Czech Republic, October 16–18, 2024.
- **2024-03** — Bergmann, M., Nathan, H., and Vercosa, J. “Robotics, AI, and the Future of Theatre.” USITT Conference & Stage Expo, Seattle, WA, March 20, 2024.
- **2023-06** — Bergmann, M., with ChatGPT. “Envisioning theatre with non-human collaborators: A Paramanifesto.” CATR Conference, Dalhousie University, Halifax, NS, June 2023.
- **2023-06** — Bergmann, M. “AI Sentience.” Panel on the Implications of AI for Performance Theorists, CATR Conference (online), June 2023.
- **2022-05** — Bergmann, M., and Thomson, B. “Stepping Back In: Taking the best of virtual delivery to a new in-person experience.” Learning & Teaching Conference, TMU, May 2022.
- **2022-05** — Bergmann, M. “Student-driven curriculum development for creative practice.” Learning & Teaching Conference, TMU, May 2022.

- **2021-10** — Bergmann, M. “Cultivating Empathy through Robotic Performance.” Limits of the Human, Machines Without Limits? Contemporary stage and robotics, University of Lausanne (online), October 2021.
- **2021-06** — Bergmann, M., O’Brien, C., and Thomson, B. “Unapologetically learning together: Adapting Production and Design curriculum to a virtual stage.” University of the Arts London (online), June 2021.
- **2021-05** — Bergmann, M., O’Brien, C., and Thomson, B. “Pandemic Performance: Adapting Production and Design curriculum to a virtual stage.” Learning & Teaching Conference, Ryerson University, May 2021.
- **2019-05** — Bergmann, M., and Thomson, B. “Putting Up the Show: The very large group project.” Ryerson Learning & Teaching Conference, May 2019.
- **2019-04** — Bergmann, M. “Theatre in TheatAR: Explorations of augmented reality in theatrical performance.” TEXT/SOUND/PERFORMANCE: Making in Canadian Space, University College Dublin, April 2019.
- **2018-03** — Bergmann, M. “Technology as a tool: Creating a mindset of embracing technology within a theatrical framework.” Theatre and Performance Design Pedagogy, University of the Arts London, March 2018.

Poster Presentations

- **2024-01** — Bergmann, M., Carravetta, L., Endahl, M., Robinson, A. D., and ARIA (AI). “Almost Alchemy.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.
- **2020-11** — Bergmann, M., and Anderson, J. “l’automate: Robotic Controlled Apparatuses for Circus Performance.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU (online), November 2020.
- **2019-11** — Bergmann, M., Zhang, ?, Laberge-Côté, ?, and McGuire, B. “Human-robot Interactions in Dance.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU, November 2019. # TODO first names
- **2018-11** — Bergmann, M. “TheatAR: A previsualization system for theatrical design.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU, November 2018.
- **2017-10** — Bergmann, M. “Shadow-selves: Projection as a medium of exploring reflections of self in Belinda McGuire’s Slaughterhouse/Requiem.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU, October 2017.
- **2017-10** — Bergmann, M. “Projecting on film: the surreal effect of rear projected backgrounds in the film Nuptials.” Poster, RUBIX, TMU, October 2017.

Invited Talks and Public Lectures

- **2025-02** — Guest lecture on AI in visual generation, open-source models, and ethical usage, Advanced Professional Projection Design (graduate), Yale University, February 14, 2025.
- **2024-12** — Host: “Beyond the Screen: Exploring AI Personhood and Their Representation in Media.” The Creative School Catalyst, Toronto, December 12, 2024.
- **2024-11** — Closing keynote: “Wellness for who? An examination of wellness through a research-creation student project.” AVARA 2024, OAMK, Oulu, Finland, November 22, 2024.
- **2024-11** — Workshop on projection design, Peterborough Theatre Guild, Peterborough, ON, November 2–3, 2024.
- **2024-10** — Provocation: “Personhood // AI.” UKAI Carnival of Shipwreck, Toronto, October 23, 2024.
- **2024-07** — Invited talk on the future of AI in the creative industries. TechTO: AI, Toronto, July 22, 2024.

- **2024-04** — “Improvnetics: Post-anthropocentric performance and improvisational modes for human-AI play.” IICSI Research Studio Session, ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 12, 2024.
- **2024-04** — Panelist on the future of AI in creativity and education, 1st Creative AI Symposium, Creative AI Hub, TMU, April 2, 2024.
- **2022-01** — Roundtable: “What is the future of creativity and AI?” with Debashis Sinha, Robert Clapperton, and Richard Lachman, RUBIX, TMU, January 27, 2022.
- **2019-11** — “Research Creation with Michael Bergmann: The Uncanny Robots Project” and “Connecting through live performance” (with Eugène Pastor, LSBU). The Catalyst @ FCAD, TMU, November 2019.

Creative Research Output

- **2026-04 – 2026-05** — “Before I Was This.” Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus.
- **2026-02** — Nuptials (feature film). Producer, projection design, and live in-camera VFX. Directed by Sean Braune, Para-sight Productions. Official release February 13, 2026 (Freestyle Digital Media). Best World Feature Film, Austin Revolution Film Festival, 2022.
- **2025-11 – 2025-11** — The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025.
- **2025-11 – 2025-11** — 291 by Jade O’Keeffe. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Lisa Dixon. Peterborough Theatre Guild, November 1–15, 2025.
- **2025-04** — “To my creators...” Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík.
- **2024-11 – 2024-11** — AVARA 2024 installation. Led eight students in a semester-long research-creation installation presented at AVARA 2024, OAMK, Oulu, Finland.
- **2024-06 – 2024-06** — Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work “To my creators...”
- **2024-04** — Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024.
- **2024-01** — Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.
- **2023-10** — “rocketmanperson.” Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, October 1, 2023.
- **2023-04** — “Who’s There?” Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, April 1, 2023.
- **2023** — Living Newspaper 2.0. Projection design; directed by Julie Labagnara. George Luscombe Theatre, Toronto.
- **2019-10** — “The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1.” Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019.

External Research Funding

- **2021** — SSHRC Partnership Engage Grant, COVID-19 Special Initiative — “Visual Music: Enhancing the National Arts Centre Orchestra’s remote connection with their audience during COVID-19 social restrictions through innovative digital tools.” PI: Cintia Cristiá; Co-Is: Michael Bergmann, David Bouchard. \$24,620.
- **2024-05** — Erasmus+ staff mobility funding, OAMK, Oulu, Finland
- **2012 – 2014** — Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University. \$40,000 USD.

Internal Research Funding

- **2024** — The Creative School Travel Grant, TMU — Shipwreck Iceland project. \$1,000.
- **2022** — TMU Work Study RA Program — “Mechanical Waves: Machine Learning gesture reactive human-robot installation.” \$3,800.
- **2022** — The Creative School Travel Grant — EVA London conference presentation. \$2,000.
- **2019** — Cirque du Soleil Entertainment Group / Future of Live Entertainment Lab — “l’automate: Expanding the possibility of performance through robotics.” Co-I with Jonathon Anderson. \$7,500.
- **2019** — FCAD Special Seed Grant — The Uncanny Robots Project. \$4,000.
- **2019** — The Creative School Travel Grant — UCD Dublin conference presentation. \$2,000.
- **2018** — Undergraduate Research Opportunity, OVPRI, Ryerson — “Augmented-Reality based Pre-Visualization system for theatrical spaces.” \$9,888.
- **2018** — Learning and Teaching Enhancement Fund, Ryerson — “The Creative Laboratory Project.” Co-I with Pavlo Bosyy. \$13,000. # NOTE: SSHRC Web CV says 2016 — resolve

Scholarships

- **2022 – 2026** — University of Guelph Graduate Tuition Scholarship. \$8,000/yr.
- **2022 – 2026** — University of Guelph University Graduate Scholarship. \$7,500/yr.

Graduate Supervision

Completed: 9 Master’s, 0 Doctoral, 0 Postdoctoral. In progress: 0.

- Aya Elmeligy, MDM (Second Reader), “Bridging Chasms: An Interactive Projection Mapping Installation for Cross-Cultural Exchange of Information.” 2022.
- Emilie Trimbee, MDM (Supervisor), “AR-based Theatrical Design Pre-Visualization using Unreal.” 2021.
- Lindsay Christopher, MDM (Supervisor), “Casting and Technology: Revamping the Audition Process.” 2021.
- Shelby Bushell, MDM (Supervisor), “Collider: Using Virtual Reality for Immersive Theatre and the Performing Arts.” 2021.
- Riley Erin Cooper, MDM (Supervisor), “Happiness In Your Hand: The power of compact Bright Light Therapy.” 2020.
- Yerachmiel Paquette, MDM (Supervisor), “The Scoop: How to Protect Your Digital Privacy in the Age of Surveillance Capitalism.” 2020.
- Kenyth Thomason, MFA in Technical Direction and Production, Yale University (Reader), “Live Video in Theatrical Productions.” 2020.

- Michael Castledine, MDM (Supervisor), “Extending the human umwelt: Reframing our understanding of an environment via mixed reality and digital soundscapes/visualizations.” 2018.
- Soo Mahabir, MDM (Supervisor), “The A.I. Storyteller: Perpetuating Orality Using Developments in Machine Learning.” 2017.

Courses Taught

- PFZ 100 — Performance Foundation (F2025) (created course)
- THP 350 — Projection Design (F 2019–24) (created course)
- THP 301–403 — Production Technique (FW 2016–present)
- THP 800 — Independent Study (W 2017–24)
- THT 582 — Show Systems Engineering (W 2020, F 2021, F 2023) (redesigned course)
- THP 102 — Production Technique II (W 2017, 2022–24) (projection design section)
- THP 202 — Production Technique IV (W 2018–24) (projection design section)
- THP 660 — Projection Design: Special Topics (W 2022) (created course)
- THF 101 — Elements of Production (F 2016, 2019, 2020)
- THM 301 — Technical Direction (F 2016)

Service

- **2026-06 – present** — Judge, Music, Film & Theatre panel, The Global Undergraduate Awards, Dublin
- **2026-04** — Co-chair (with Dr. Afsoon Soudi), 3rd Annual Creative AI Symposium, Creative AI Hub, TMU
- **2025-07 – present** — Member, Creative AI Hub Steering Committee, The Creative School, TMU
- **2025-02 – present** — Member, USITT Research and Creative Endeavours Committee
- **2024-12 – present** — Member, Faculty Tenure Committee, The Creative School, TMU
- **2024-11 – present** — Board Member, UKAI Projects
- **2024-06 – present** — Reviewer, International Journal of Performance Arts and Digital Media
- **2023-10 – present** — Jury Member, CATR Scholarship and Grant Committee (Heather McCallum Scholarship, Robert Lawrence Scholarship, CATR Grants)
- **2023 – present** — Reviewer, EVA London Conference on Electronic Visualisation and the Arts
- **2023 – 2024** — Technical Advisory Board Member, UKAI Projects
- **2023 – 2024** — Member, 360 Working Group, School of Performance, TMU
- **2023** — Reviewer, Canada Foundation for Innovation
- **2022 – 2024** — Senator (The Creative School faculty representative), TMU Senate
- **2022-03 – 2023** — Secretary of the Board, Guild Festival Theatre
- **2020 – present** — Coordinator, Global Campus Studio course, TMU
- **2018 – 2020** — FCAD Teaching Committee; FCAD Interdisciplinary Advisory Committee
- **2016 – 2021** — Member, Stage Committee, Arts & Letters Club of Toronto

Memberships and Collectives

- **2025 – present** — Canadian Artificial Intelligence Association
- **2023 – present** — Almost Alchemy — improvised, multi-disciplinary performance collective (founding member)
- **2022 – 2023** — Synectic Assembly — AI-driven art collective (founding member)

- **2021 – 2022** — Diagonal — speaker series and reading group, BMO Lab, University of Toronto
- **2019 – present** — United States Institute for Theatre Technology (USITT)
- **2018 – present** — Associated Designers of Canada / IATSE Local ADC 659
- **2018 – present** — Canadian Institute for Theatre Technology (CITT)

Interviews and Media

- **2023** — “Get the inside scoop on game-changing innovations in augmented reality with the new VisionPro.” The Creative School Top 5, July 4, 2023.
- **2023** — Faculty Spotlight: Michael F Bergmann. Performance at The Creative School, June 27, 2023.
- **2022** — “Students Are Excited And Hopeful For What The Metaverse May Bring.” The Eyeopener, October 5, 2022.
- **2022** — “Michael F. Bergmann On The Merging of Live Arts and Technology.” Toronto Life, April 29, 2022.
- **2021** — “Emerging technology that’s here to stay.” CityNews Toronto, June 18, 2021.
- **2020** — “Can you feel empathy for a dancing robot?” Ryerson Innovation Magazine, Issue 33, 2020.
- **2019** — “Premiere of robot dance performance launches Creative Technology Lab.” Ryerson University, November 2019.
- **2015** — Q&A Personal interview, Meghan Perkins, Live Design Magazine, 2015.